

Enjoy Minecraft on Raspberry Pi

If you own a Raspberry Pi and have a fetish for virtual games, you'll be happy to hear that one of the biggest game developers, Mojang, has introduced its Minecraft game for the ARM-powered Linux-based Raspberry Pi mini



computer. The Raspberry Pi Foundation had given it the green light and had sent the device samples to developers at Mojang to tweak it. Developers came up with a Raspberry Pi version of the game named Minecraft: Pi Edition. The game has support for many programming languages and users can access the codes of the game too. The game is available for free.

"Users can create a LAN set-up and start gaming while learning the basics of programming on the Raspberry Pi. Users can modify the game world with code," said Owen Hill, chief world officer of Mojang.

A few weeks back, there was news about a game named BerryBot, which would help users learn the basics of programming while playing. Patrick Cupka, the proprietor of The Void, has developed BerryBots 1.0.0 for the Raspberry Pi, Linux and Mac OS X platforms. The BerryBot game requires a player to code a ship to sail across and complete a simple stage. The ship has to be programmed to shoot at other ships and to do other simple jobs. The BerryBots game is written in Lua. It seems like the idea of learning while gaming is slowly picking up on the Raspberry Pi.

Splashtop Streamer, which supports the Linux-based operating system.

Ubuntu users can install the Ubuntu package on their desktops and use Splashtop's mobile apps to connect to their computers, remotely. The apps are available for Android and iOS smartphones. A nominal subscription fee of \$1 or a yearly fee of \$10 has to be paid. The price may vary for tablet variants of the mobile app.

According to Splashtop, this is a good alternative for standard virtual network computing and other remote desktop technologies. Cliff Miller, chief marketing officer, Splashtop said, "Technologically savvy users will like the feature more than the general public will. In fact, this was the factor behind why Splashtop was motivated for an Ubuntu release. We have been working on the Linux version for some time. We just needed to produce it to bring this Ubuntu release."

The new streamer should be compatible with other Linux distributions as well, said Miller. However, the company is not supporting them officially and users of other Linux distros may also need to tweak the software a bit. The company can come up with versions for other Linux-based distributions apart from Ubuntu, depending upon the market demand.

According to a statement from Splashtop's CEO Mark Lee, the company is giving the user a few ways to tweak the configuration files to stream at different frame rates that it thinks Linux folks will appreciate.

New improved Aakash-2 Android ICS tablet launched

The president of India, Pranab Mukherjee, recently launched the much-awaited Aakash 2 tablet in New Delhi. Packed with new features, the new version is based on a dual-core Cortex A9 processor clocked at 1 GHz along with 512 MB of RAM. Compared to the first Aakash tablet, which was based on a 366 MHz processor and an older ARM architecture, this new tablet is definitely more advanced. The new Aakash tablet runs Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich and we expect it to be smooth, as the hardware backing it seems good enough for Android 4.0.

The cost of the device is Rs 2,263. The Indian government will purchase it at this price and then distribute it to 220 million students across India in the coming five to six years at a subsidised price of Rs 1,130. "The government subsidises it



Aakash 2 can run Linux distributions along with the Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich operating system. The device can also do Aadhar authentication and can remotely control a robot, according to HRD Ministry officials. The tablet will be primarily used for classroom teaching, and over 15,000 teachers at 250 colleges across the country have been provided training.

by 50 per cent and it will be distributed to students at Rs 1,130. The government is also trying to motivate the state governments to further subsidise it, so that the Aakash 2 can be distributed to students for free," said Suneet Tuli, CEO, Datawind.